

# Richard Taylor Robinson

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## Education / Certification

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Master of Science in Journalism – Northwestern University, Medill School of Journalism     | AUG 2026  |
| TEFL Certificate – Language Link School, St. Petersburg, Russia                            | OCT 2018  |
| Bachelor of Arts in Cognitive Science – Occidental College                                 | MAY 2018  |
| Minors: Comparative Studies in Russian Literature & Culture                                | MAY 2018  |
| Saint Petersburg State University, St. Petersburg, Russia, Russian Language and Literature | FALL 2016 |

## Languages

**English** – native

**Russian** – fluent

**Spanish** – conversational

## Experience

**INDEPENDENT JOURNALIST**, INDEPENDENT; INTERNATIONAL PRESENT

- Reported and lived in various countries: *Russia; The Republic of Georgia; Argentina; Latvia*
- Published a story with The New Eastern Europe on Russian media-in-exile while reporting in Latvia
- Soon publishing a piece with Borderless magazine about a Venezuelan family who crossed the Darién gap only to be denied due process in immigration court under Trump
- Reporting on the situation at the border in El Paso and Juarez, in talks with Borderless to publish
- Pitching a story written on the right to sit in the workplace, contains interviews with an Illinois representative and employees discussing problems with their employers on the record

**INDEPENDENT DOCUMENTARIAN/PHOTOJOURNALIST**, INDEPENDENT; INTERNATIONAL PRESENT

- Filmed, edited and produced an independent documentary in Tbilisi following Russia's invasion of Ukraine about the influx of Russian exiles and Ukrainian refugees.
- Spoke with Georgians, Russians, Ukrainians and even a Russian woman who supports the war
- Produced two photo essays, capturing emotion and vulnerability with intimate access
- One about a Chicago resident experiencing homelessness after 10 years in prison
- Another about a Rohingya immigrant who survived being lost at sea for 90 days before becoming a case worker for refugees in Chicago

**EFL TEACHER**, ST. PETERSBURG, RUSSIA; TBILISI, GEORGIA; BUENOS AIRES, ARGENTINA; CHICAGO, IL OCT 2018-JUNE 2025

- Educate people of all walks of life in foreign countries as well as immigrants and refugees in the U.S. learn English as a second language

## Activities

- |                                                                              |              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| • <b>EFL Teaching Volunteer</b> , Peer Learners weekly speaking club, online | 2022-PRESENT |
| • <b>Volunteer</b> , Chuco's Youth Justice Coalition, Inglewood, CA          | 2016-PRESENT |
| • <b>Independent Musician</b> , "Dingo Paisley" (stage-name)                 | 2015-PRESENT |

## Skills

- **Communication Skills**: outgoing; personable; open-minded and excited to speak to people from vastly different backgrounds
- **Journalism**: filing FOIAs; photography; photo-editing in Adobe Lightroom; documentary production; video-editing in Final Cut Pro